READ AND RESPOND

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Read the passage twice. Answer the questions; circle one answer for the multiple choice and write full sentences for the others. Underline the part of the text that helped you.

How Animals Get Through Winter

161 words

When the days turn short and cold, animals have three main ways to cope: leave, sleep, or adapt. Many birds leave. Arctic terns fly from the far north almost to the South Pole and back every year, a trip of about 44,000 miles. Other animals sleep. A groundhog's heart slows from about 80 beats a minute to only 5, and its body temperature drops close to freezing. This deep sleep is called hibernation, and it lets the groundhog live for months on fat it stored in the fall. Bears also sleep, but less deeply; a mother bear can wake to care for her cubs. The rest adapt. Snowshoe hares grow thick white fur that hides them in snow and grow extra fur on their feet, which act like snowshoes. Chickadees, small birds that stay all winter, fluff their feathers to trap warm air and shiver to make heat. They can eat half their body weight every day just to stay warm.

1. About how far does an Arctic tern travel in a year?

4,400 miles | 44,000 miles | 440 miles

2. Which animal sleeps less deeply and can wake to care for its young?

the groundhog | the snowshoe hare | the bear

3. Name two ways a snowshoe hare's body changes for winter.

4. Why do you think a chickadee needs to eat so much food in winter? THINK

READ AND RESPOND ANSWER KEY

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the groundhog | the snowshoe hare | **the bear**

3. Name two ways a snowshoe hare's body changes for winter.

Its fur turns thick and white (to hide in snow), and extra fur grows on its feet (to act like snowshoes).

4. Why do you think a chickadee needs to eat so much food in winter? THINK

It uses a lot of energy to make heat (shivering) and stay warm in the cold, so it needs more food than in summer.

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